Fig. 3 - Levels of assessment: what is checked, against what, and who decides

Checks internal to the record verify integrity; checks that reach outside it verify warrant. Findings at Levels 1–3; signed decisions above the line.

Level	The question	Who	Output	What follows
4 · New, then interesting	**New:** does the paper add to what is known: an answer to a question already posed, a question not posed before, a reading of results in hand, or new evidence on a claim already stated? Judged on the question the paper states. **Interesting:** should this community attend to it now (Davis 1971)?	New: one editor, on the map. Interesting: the editor and two named reviewers.	Two signed judgments under published criteria; then the publication and the certificate, or nothing.	Published and certified, or returned with nothing travelling. No partial certificate.
	Above the line, named people decide and sign. Below it, the machine emits findings with pointers, never a verdict.			
3 · Warrant	Do the claims match the evidence offered, judged against what the record does not supply: the published standard for the modality, the literature (the evidence map), re-execution under perturbation? External: verifies warrant.	Machine, reaching outside the record (SIEVE modules)	Findings with a pointer to the record and to the standard applied; the evidence map.	Strengthen the evidence or weaken the claims. Above the published threshold: return without review.
2 · Correspondence	Does the paper match the appendix, and the appendix the record, read through the AI appendix? Completeness, resolution, anchors. Internal: verifies integrity.	Machine	Findings checkable from the record alone.	Unresolved pointer or empty evidence: return for corrections, no new work (match paper, appendix, record). Partial evidence goes to review with the finding.
1 · Form	Does the record conform to the published protocol for its declared type: parts present, the paper's front notice, declarations made, the AI appendix in the published form or produced on intake? Internal.	Machine	Findings; nothing is rejected on form.	The author's AI brings the record to the protocol. Return for corrections.

Findings describe the paper; actions are what the journal does next. The published mapping links them, a named editor applies it, and departures are recorded with their reason. An AI-written paper passes Levels 1–2 by construction; Level 3 is where the AI-age work is done.

Verification — the machine checks the record, internally for integrity and externally for warrant, links each finding to evidence and to the standard applied, and versions it with the model that produced it.

findings

Judgment — named people decide whether the contribution is new and whether it is of interest to this community, under published criteria, and sign.

decisions

Accountability — people answer for decisions, not for findings. The mapping is published, departures are recorded, and the departure rate is public, so a journal that automates is visible.

A desk rejection today: rarely explained and difficult to contest.
A return here: a finding with a pointer, a published rule, and a name; the author holds their own report from the same checks, so a return rests on a finding they saw or on one marked as absent from their run.

Journal · Author + AI · Machine · Named people · runs in Mark 1 · specified only · decision: a person only